"We have embraced western culture rapidly, but we are also steeped in our traditions, giving us a balanced outlook"

beaches. My country is a small world in itself.

I believe that as a result of this diversity, India is a slow yet fast-developing country in different ways. The way that people are evolving and inculcating western culture is rapid but at the same time keeping in mind age-old traditions and following them has helped them maintain a balance. Overall, I believe India will become one of the most famous, balanced and welcoming countries in the future, inviting people from all over the world. ■





46TH ANNIVERSARY YOUTHSPEAK

DHIREN REDDY, 20, HYDERABAD

Management Studies, Symbiosis Centre for Management Studies, **Pune**

Self-Reliance for Self-Respect

My vision of India is for it to be regarded as a highly developed country rather than a developing one. We are among the top seven countries in terms of GDP, our poverty rates have been falling and our achievements are being globally recognised. However, we still lack the confidence to see ourselves as a developed nation. Here's why: people here are obsessed with foreign goods; everyone wants foreign technology, even foreign shirts. We have heard it often, that self-respect comes from self-reliance. I want to live in an India that is self-reliant.

The media in India is so negative—only the deaths, terrorism, crimes and scams make headlines, while all the breaking news, achievements and strengths are buried among other news. We are a great nation and the people of India need to be aware of their successes. I want to live in an India where people wake up and recognise India's strengths instead of reading negative headlines.

My vision is to see India as a developed, self-reliant and self-assured nation. ■